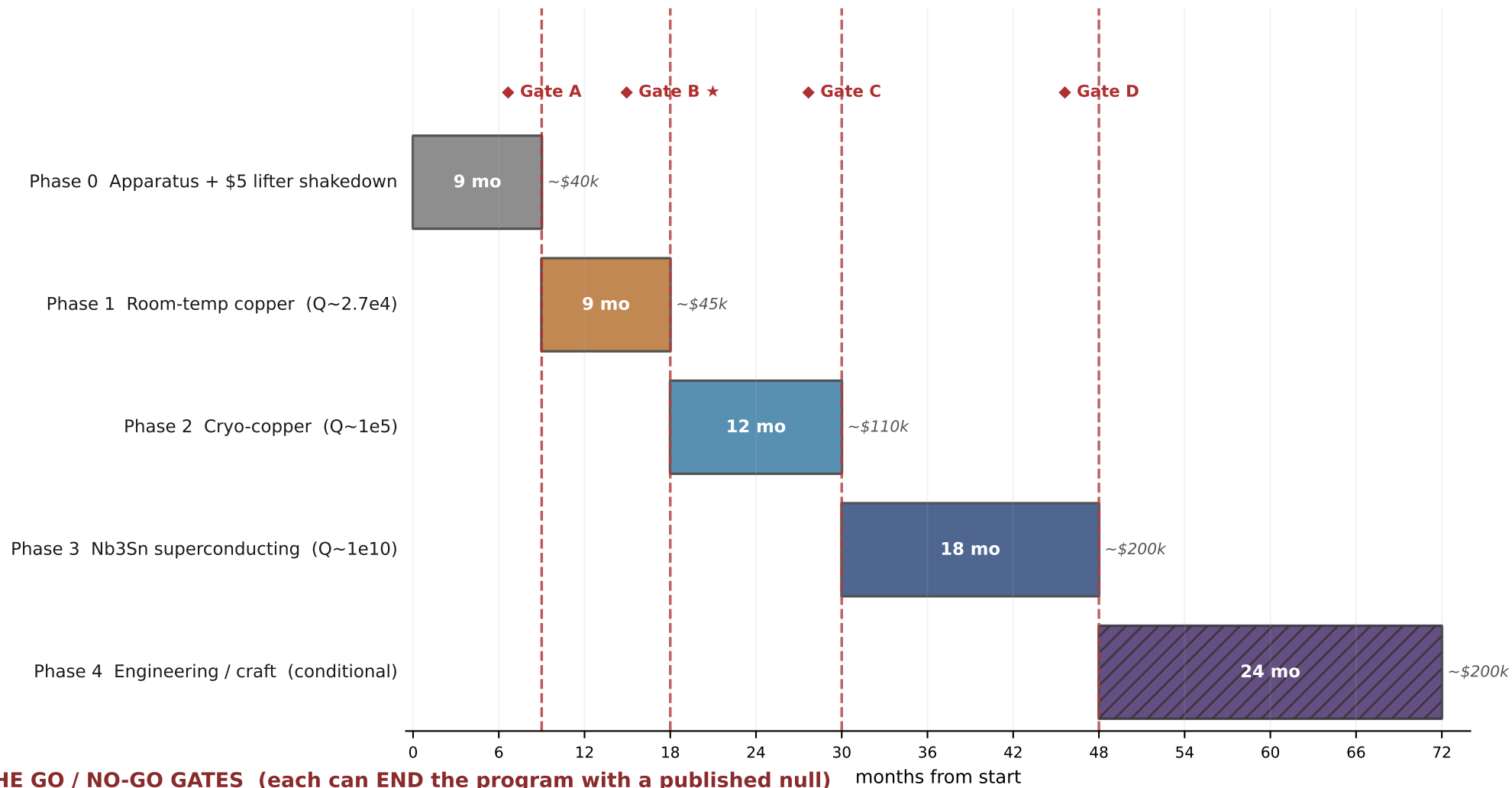


Horizon-Drive Build Timeline — First Experiment → Final Product

A staged bet with KILL-GATES: a null result at any gate ends the program with a publishable bound.



◆ **Gate A — rig validated?**
if NULL → FAIL → fix rig, not physics

◆ **Gate C — $F \propto Q$ slope real?**
if NULL → NULL → tighter bound → STOP

◆ **Gate B — signal or bound?**
if NULL → NULL → publish bound → STOP

◆ **Gate D — independently**
if NULL → no → report systematic → STOP

HONEST FRAMING

Decisive physics answer (Gates B-C): ~2-2.5 yr, ~\$110k. Most likely outcome: a clean NULL + the Q-scaling methodology, published, STOP — a full success. Phases 3-4 exist only in the ~1% world where the effect is real and independently replicated. The craft is the destination, not the plan.